A-A-53231A
15 March 1989
SUPERSEDING
A-A-0053231(DM)
9 October 1987

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

FORCEPS, HEMOSTATIC CLIP APPLYING, SMALL, SERRATED JAWS, ANGLED

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description.

This commercial item description covers various sized hemostatic clip applying forceps with angled jaws.

Salient characteristics:

General. The forceps shall be small size hemostatic clip applying forceps, used to apply small size hemostatic clips. The clips may be fabricated of stainless steel or tantalum (See Note 2). The terms applicable to hemostatic forceps and their components shall be in accordance with ASTM Designation F921.

Material. The forceps shall be fabricated from Class 4 martensitic stainless steel in accordance with ASTM Designation F899.

Hardness. The forceps shall have a Rockwell Hardness C scale (HRC) of 40 to 47 in accordance with ASTM Designations E18 or E92. Conversion of Vickers hardness values to Rockwell values shall be in accordance with ASTM Designation E140.

Passivation. The forceps shall be passivated.

Finish. The forceps shall be mirror, satin, or matte. If the forceps have a mirror finish, the locks and ratchet shall be polished smooth, but need not have a mirror finish. The matte finish shall exhibit a uniform non-directional surface texture equivalent to that produced by lightly blasting the prepared surface with fine abrasives under pressure.

AMSC N/A FSC 6515

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Corrosion-resistance. The forceps shall show no signs of corrosion when tested in accordance with ASTM Designation F1089.

Style and design. Shall be a ring-handled forceps of box lock construction having an overall length of 5-3/4 inches for the small size, 7-1/2 inches for the medium size or 10-1/2 inches for the large size. The distal end of the jaws shall be at 15 or 45 degree angle to the handles. The jaw faces shall be serrated. The handle rings shall be color coded to match the color of the clip cartridge. There shall be a spring between the handles to return the forceps to their open position, maintaining continuous pressure on the clips during transfer. The forceps shall be in accordance with DPSC Drawing No. 23350.

Performance. The clips shall not fall out of the jaws when the jaws are held vertically downward when tested as specified herein. The forceps shall close the clips as specified in DPSC Drawing No. 23350 when tested as specified herein. Box lock performance shall be as specified in ASTM Designation F1026.

Identification marking and labeling. The forceps shall bear the contractor's name or registered trademark and the word "stainless". Forceps of foreign manufacture shall bear the name of the country of manufacture.

Workmanship. Box lock workmanship shall be as specified in ASTM Designation F1026. The forceps shall be free from burrs, cracks, sharp edges, scale, corrosion or other defects which detract from its appearance or impair its serviceability.

Unit. Each (EA). One forceps, as specified, constitutes one unit.

Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

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Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item. Defects to be inspected include but are not limited to the following:

Forceps not of the specified design for appropriate type, stock number and item identification.
Both jaws not serrated as specified.
Jaw serrations not of uniform depth and not well defined.
Forceps not free from cracks, pits, burs, sharp edges, scale, rough areas or corrosion.
Finish of forceps not uniform and not as specified.
Box lock performance not as specified.
Pin for box lock not flush with surface and not free from crevices.
Forceps not free from dirt, polishing material or foreign matter.
Identification markings not present, not correct, not complete, or not legible.

Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

Clip retention. Place cartridge containing the hemostatic clips on a horizontal surface. With forceps open, place jaws in cartridge cavity containing the clip until it touches the bottom. This will deform the clip to the jaw shape. Remove the clip from the cartridge and hold the forceps with the jaws vertically downward. Without closing the jaws, the clip should remain grasped for one minute. Repeat five times.

Clip closure. Close the forceps containing the clip. Remove the clip and measure the gap and scissor. Reject forceps not producing clips which conform to the measurements stated in DPSC Drawing 23350. Repeat five times.

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Sampling for tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as specified herein. The inspection level shall be S-2. Dimensional testing shall be at a 2.5% AQL. Copper sulfate and boil testing shall be at a 1.0% AQL, and clip retention and clip closure testing shall be at a 4.0% AQL. The unit of product for tests purposes shall be one forceps.

Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producers' own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Metric products. Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch-pound units, providing they fall within the tolerances specified using conversion tables contained in the latest revision of Federal Standard No. 376, and all other requirements of this document are met.

If a product is manufactured to metric dimensions and those dimensions exceed the tolerances specified in the inch/pound units, a request should be made to the contracting officer to determine if the product is acceptable.

The contracting officer has the option of accepting or rejecting the product.

Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

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Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Public Law 94-580, as amended, and as implemented by Federal Acquisition Regulation Subpart 23.4 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

NOTE 1: The following National Stock Numbers iscovered by this document:

NSN	ITEM IDENTIFICATION
6515-01-167-6670	FORCEPS, HEMOSTATIC CLIP, Applying, Small, Angled 15°, 7-1/2 Inch

NOTE 2: The following National Stock Numbers represent these clips:

NSN	ITEM IDENTIFICATION
6515-01-156-2603	CLIP, HEMOSTATIC, Corrosion-Resisting Steel, 216 Clips In 36 Cartridges
6515-01-173-8925	CLIP, HEMOSTATIC, Tantalum, 216 Clips In 36 Cartridges

Ordering data (Intermediate/exterior package quantities and labeling and marking must be specified in the contract and/or order).

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Preparing Activity:

DoD-MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

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CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA-OSS
PHS
FDA-MPQAS

Project No. 6515-4550

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